

Hilltown Youth Theatre

A Midsummer Night's
Dream

The Athenians

Theseus – Duke of Athens
Hippolyta – Queen of the Amazons
Hermia – in love with Lysander
Helena – in love with Demetrius
Lysander – in love with Hermia
Demetrius – suitor to Hermia
Egeus – Hermia's father
Philostrate – Theseus' Master of Revels
Tragedy, Comedy, Astronomy, and Dance- Muses(narrators)

The Mechanicals

Peter Quince – a carpenter, their director and speaks the prologue
Nick Bottom – a weaver, plays 'Pyramus'
Francis Flute – a bellows-mender, plays 'Thisbe'
Snug – a joiner, plays 'Lion'
Tom Snout – a tinker, plays 'Wall'
Robin Starveling – a tailor, plays 'Moonshine'

The Fairies

Oberon – King of the Fairies
Titania – Queen of the Fairies
Puck – Oberon's knavish sprite
Peaseblossom, Cobweb, Moth, Mustardseed, Bumblebug, Mayfly,
Jynsomweed, Juniper Berry, Dahlia, Silkworm, Sapling– servants to Titania
Changeling child – a ward of Titania

SCENE I.

Athens. The palace of THESEUS.

Enter THESEUS, HIPPOLYTA, PHILOSTRATE, and Attendants

Three statues on platforms, one TRAGEDY, one COMEDY, and one MUSIC.

COMEDY

I come hither this day

To present to you this comedy

She by my side is the muse of tragedy

TRAGEDY

Hi.

COMEDY

She still is grieving the last play. I will give her some time. Our tale begins in Athens, where the King Theseus is preparing to wed the Queen of the Amazons, Hippolyta

THESEUS

Now, fair Hippolyta, our nuptial hour

Draws on apace; four happy days bring in

Another moon: but, O, methinks, how slow

This old moon wanes! she lingers my desires,

Long withering out a young man revenue.

HIPPOLYTA

Four days will quickly steep themselves in night;

Four nights will quickly dream away the time;

TRAGEDY

But all is not happy, enter the duke Egeus, the father of fair Hermia who is to be wedded to Demetrius, whom she loves not.

ASTRONOMY

And behind her, her truest love Lysander, and closest confidant Helena, who loves Demetrius.

COMEDY

But Hermia refuses to abide by Theseus' council and pleads with him.

ASTRONOMY

Oh and I'm the muse of astronomy, the stars have told me how this goes but I shan't spoil it. Proceed, Hermia.

HERMIA

I would my father look'd but with my eyes.

THESEUS

Rather your eyes must with his judgment look.

HERMIA

I do entreat your grace to pardon me.

I know not by what power I am made bold,

But I beseech your grace that I may know
The worst that may befall me in this case,
If I refuse to wed Demetrius.

THESEUS

Either to die the death or to abjure
For ever the society of men.

Therefore, fair Hermia, question your desires; Know of
your youth, examine well your blood, Whether, if you
yield not to your father's choice, You can endure the
livery of a nun,
Chanting faint hymns to the cold fruitless moon.

HIPPOLYTA

Take time to pause; and, by the next new moon-- Upon
that day either prepare to die
For disobedience to your father's will,
Or else to wed Demetrius, as he would;
Or on Diana's altar to protest
For aye austerity and single life.

DEMETRIUS

Relent, sweet Hermia.

LYSANDER

You have her father's love, Demetrius;
Let me have Hermia's:

EGEUS

She is mine, and all my right of her
I do estate unto Demetrius.

COMEDY

But the lovers vow to stay together, and Lysander has concocted a scheme so they may escape the cruel arm of
Athenian law.

LYSANDER

Ay me! for aught that I could ever read,
Could ever hear by tale or history,
The course of true love never did run smooth;
But hear me, Hermia. I have a widow aunt, a dowager
Of great revenue, and she hath no child:
From Athens is her house remote seven leagues;
And she respects me as her only son.
There, gentle Hermia, may I marry thee;
And to that place the sharp Athenian law

Cannot pursue us. If thou lovest me then,
Steal forth thy father's house tonight;
And in the wood, a league without the town,
There will I stay for thee.

HERMIA

My good Lysander!
I swear to thee, by Cupid's strongest bow,
To-morrow truly will I meet with thee.

TRAGEDY

Enter Helena, who loves Demetrius. It seemed once that they would be betrothed, but Demetrius fell for fair Hermia, as many were known to do, and he cast poor Helena aside.

HELENA

How happy some o'er other some can be!
Through Athens I am thought as fair as she.
But what of that? Demetrius thinks not so;
He will not know what all but he do know:
And as he errs, doting on Hermia's eyes,
So I, admiring of his qualities:
Love looks not with the eyes, but with the mind;
And therefore is wing'd Cupid painted blind:
For ere Demetrius look'd on Hermia's eyne,
He hail'd down oaths that he was only mine;
And when this hail some heat from Hermia felt,
So he dissolved, and showers of oaths did melt.
I will go tell him of fair Hermia's flight:
Then to the wood will he this very night
Pursue her; and for this intelligence
If I have thanks, it is a dear expense:
But herein mean I to enrich my pain,
To have his sight thither and back again.

Exit

ASTRONOMY

To Demetrius she runs and reveals the plan of the fleeing lovers. He gives chase to Hermia and her beloved, with Helena at his heels. And into the woods the mortal lovers go.

Scarborough Fair